Practical 5: Build the RetailPulse Sales Prompt Report

Related topic: Design a Cognos Prompt Report for Sales Analysis

Objective

Design a prompt page with value, date-range, and cascading prompts, and link each control to a report filter.

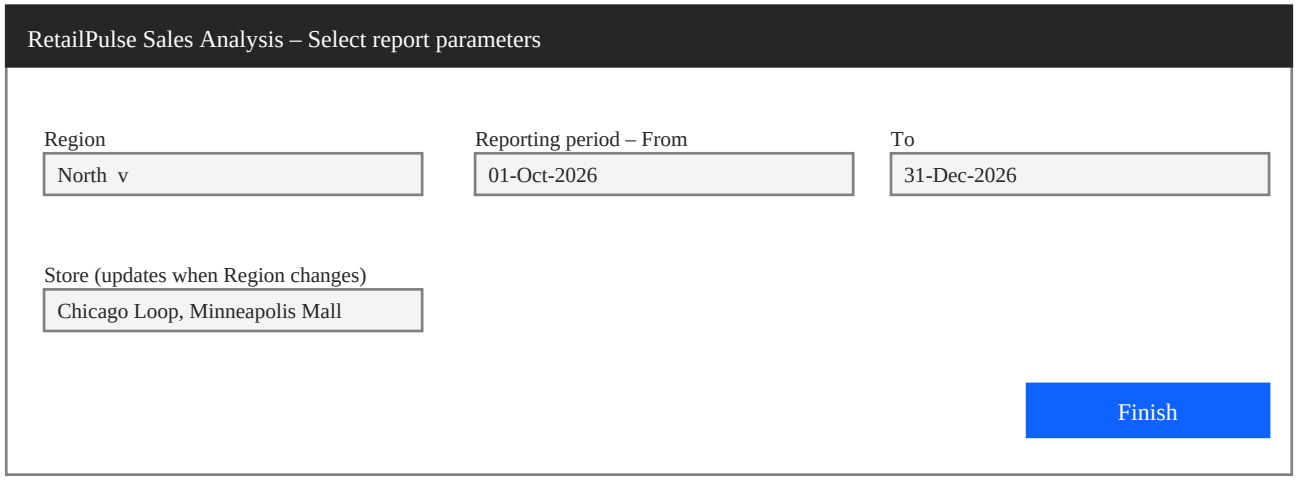
Materials required

IBM Cognos Analytics access, the RetailPulse Region-Product Crosstab from Practical 4.

Step-by-step procedure

1. Open the **RetailPulse Region-Product Crosstab** report.
2. Open the **Pages** tab (Page explorer) and add a **Prompt page** ahead of the crosstab page.
3. Drag a **Value prompt** onto the prompt page; set Parameter = **Region**, Use = [Region], Display = [Region]. Drag a **Date range** (Date & Time) prompt; Parameter = **Period** (range).
4. Add another **Value prompt** for **Store Name** and set its **Cascade source** to the Region prompt, so its list only shows stores of the selected region.
5. On the crosstab page, create filters: `[Region] = ?Region?`, `[Store Name] in (?Store?)`, `[Sales Date] in_range ?Period?` so each prompt is linked to its filter.
6. Set **Default selections** (Region = North; Period = current quarter) on each prompt, add a **Finish** button, then **Run** and test: choose North, then re-run with South.

Expected output (illustrative prompt page)



Mock-up of the prompt page: Region value prompt, date-range prompt, cascading Store prompt, Finish button. Changing Region to South changes the store list to Atlanta Peachtree / Miami Beach.

Expected outcome
All three controls render; changing Region refreshes the Store list without error; Finish returns a crosstab filtered to the chosen values; defaults produce a sensible report with no changes.